Case Studies

Andrew Dobbs

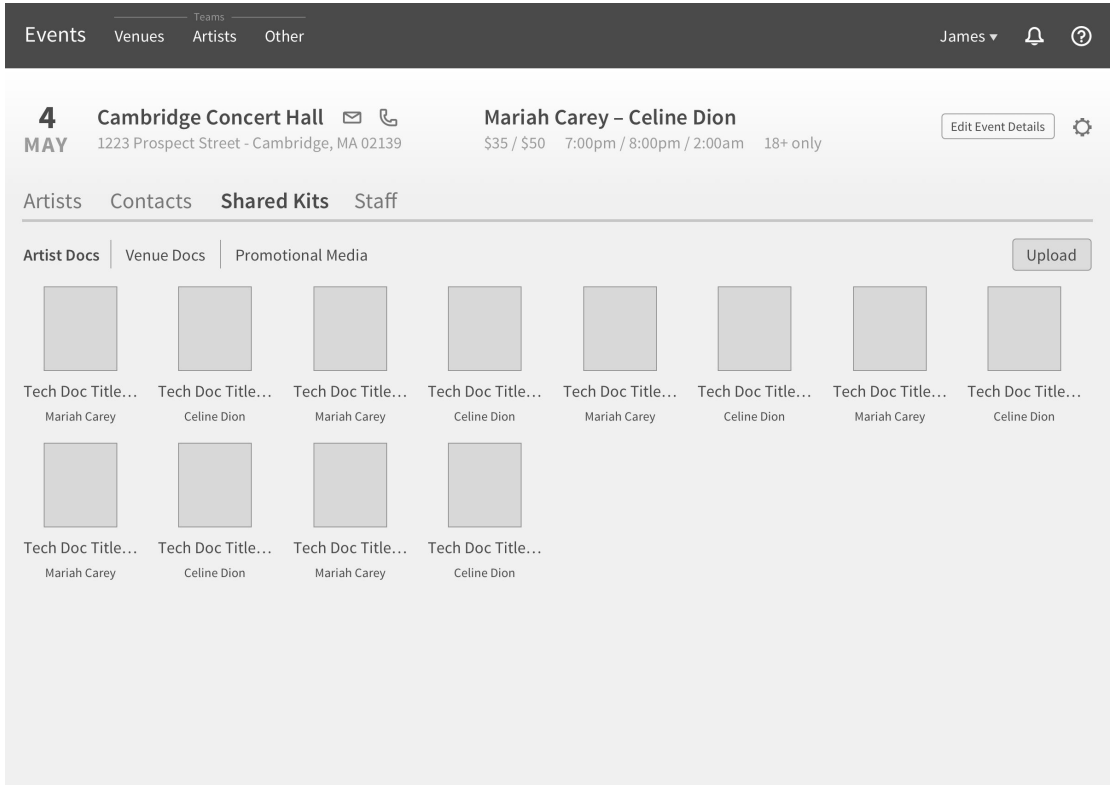
Customer First

Customer-Driven Product Design at a Seed Stage Startup

Create Prechorus and achieve market fit in seven months or less.

Solution

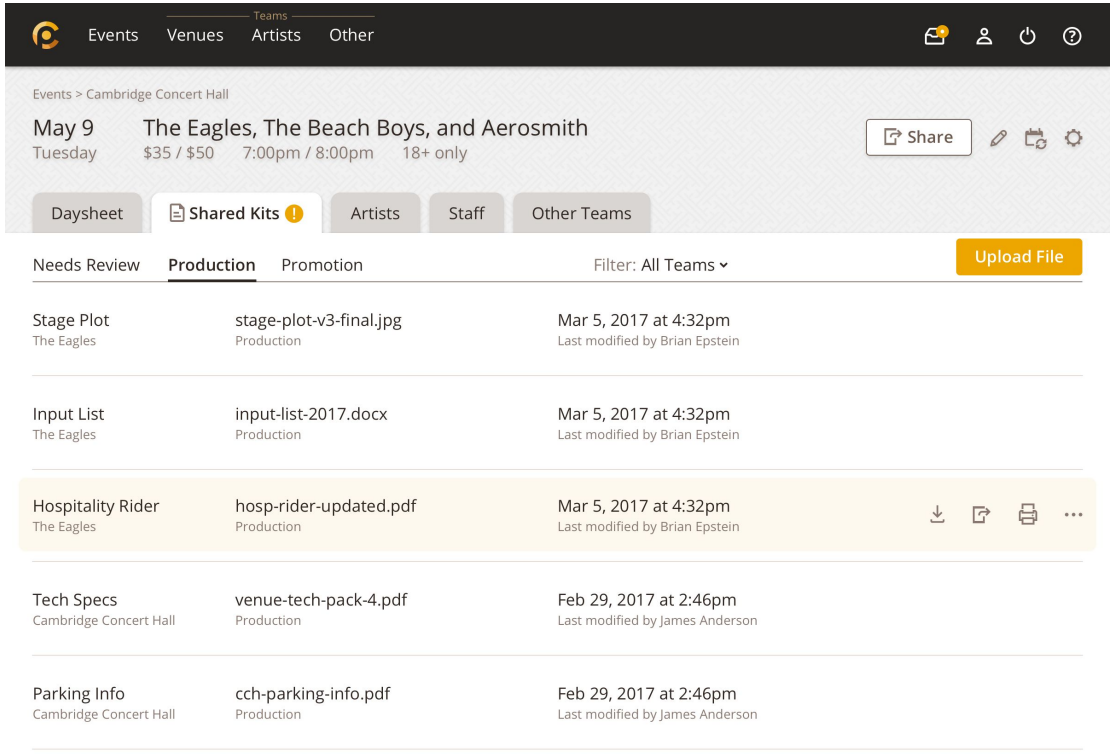
1. Understand the problem and define feature requirements through hands-on user research with target customers.
2. Create a customer-driven roadmap and translate high-level goals into prioritized work items.
3. Involve the whole team in the design process and iterate through continuous customer feedback.



Wireframe of document sharing feature

Results

1. Signed up the two largest companies in our target market for closed beta.
2. Nailed product/market fit in the first demo for a business owner and key prospect who had never seen the product before.
3. Designed an interface prospective customers described as “Clean,” “Warm,” and “Professional.”



Design of document sharing feature. (I did all design work for the entire app and contributed to front end development).

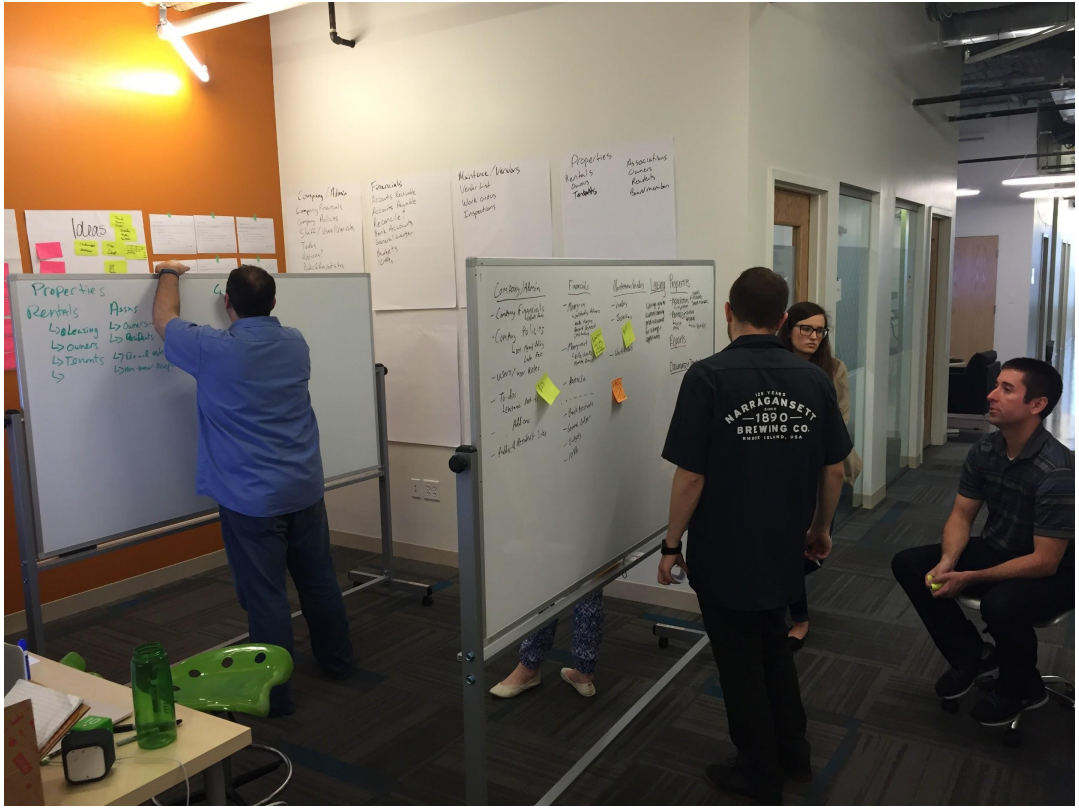
Lost and Confused

Busting through Functional Silos to Fix Navigation Failure

Buildium prospects and customers couldn’t find the features they need to manage their properties.

Solution

1. Revise our global navigation to match the mental model of property managers.
2. Identify opportunities to connect related tasks, improve terminology, and reduce complexity.
3. Bring together a cross-functional team to explore every path and socialize our findings.



Day two of cross-functional design sprint I facilitated.

Results

1. Improved the success rate for finding core tasks across the application from 66% to 80%.
2. Reduced the number of clicks taken to reach those tasks by 10%.
3. Piloted the first design sprint for the company and established a new cross-functional process.

Rentals	Financials	Maintenance	Leasing
Properties	Accounts receivable	Work orders	Listings
Rent roll	Accounts payable	Vendors	Applicants
Tenants	Bank accounts	Bills	Draft leases
Rental owners	Company financials	Inspections	Renewals
Outstanding balances	Tax filings		

Our revised app structure, validated through tree testing I led.

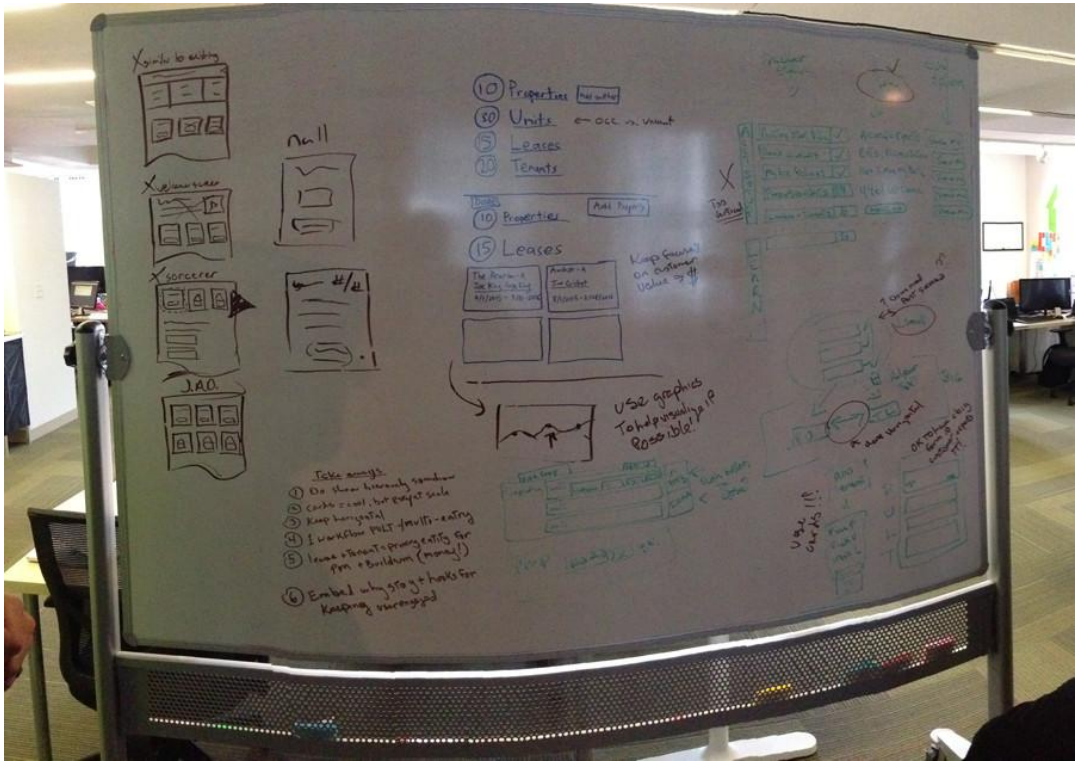
All Aboard

SaaS Product Onboarding at a High Growth Startup

New Buildium customers were dumped onto an empty dashboard with no idea how to get started.

Solution

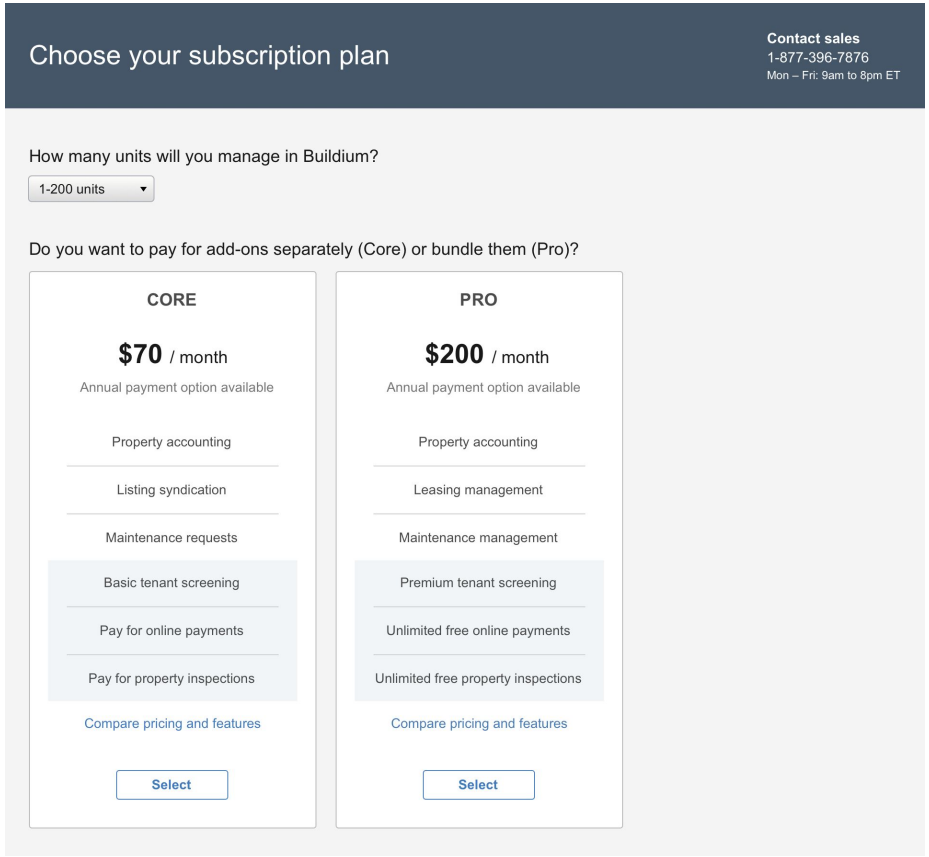
1. Improve users' commitment to get started by increasing yearly subscriptions.
2. Guide users through a setup process that helps them configure settings and enter data.
3. Reduce the effort and complexity of onboarding by streamlining the existing workflow.



Whiteboard of ideas for new onboarding experience.

Results

1. Increased the percentage of users who sign up for yearly plans from ~12% to ~31%.
2. Retained more new customers by reducing churn for a reason of “too hard to use” from ~30% to ~18%.
3. Simplified from 17 screens spread across the application to 7 screens in a unified workflow.



Design for in-product free trial upgrade options.

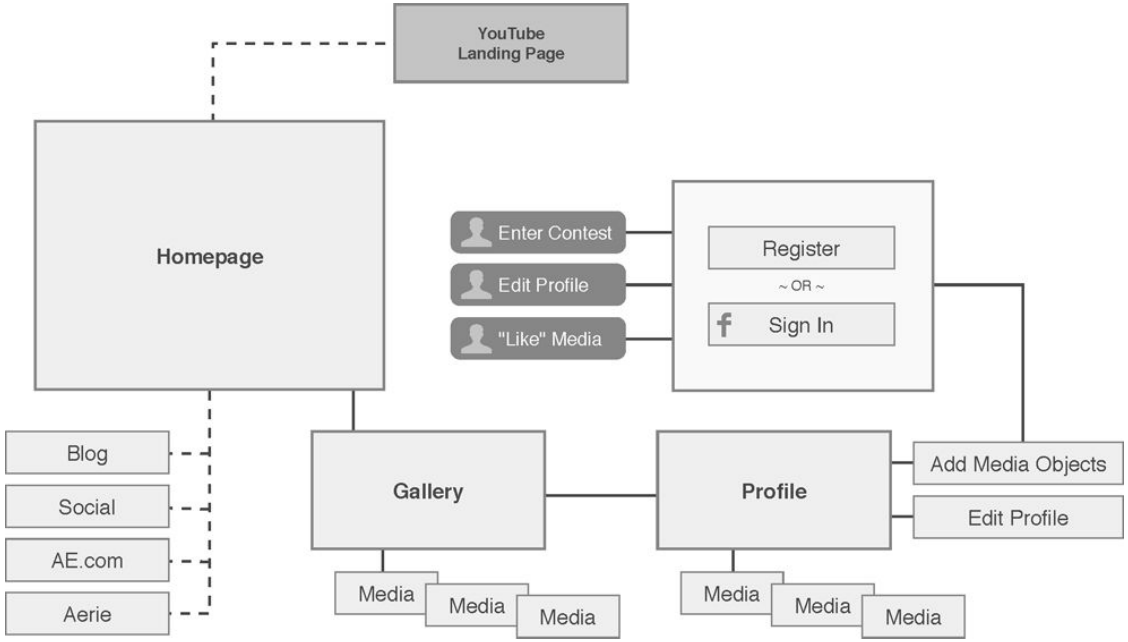
Done Yesterday

A Lean Contest Platform for a Large Consumer Brand

American Eagle was in sore need of a powerful yet simple platform for running model contests online.

Solution

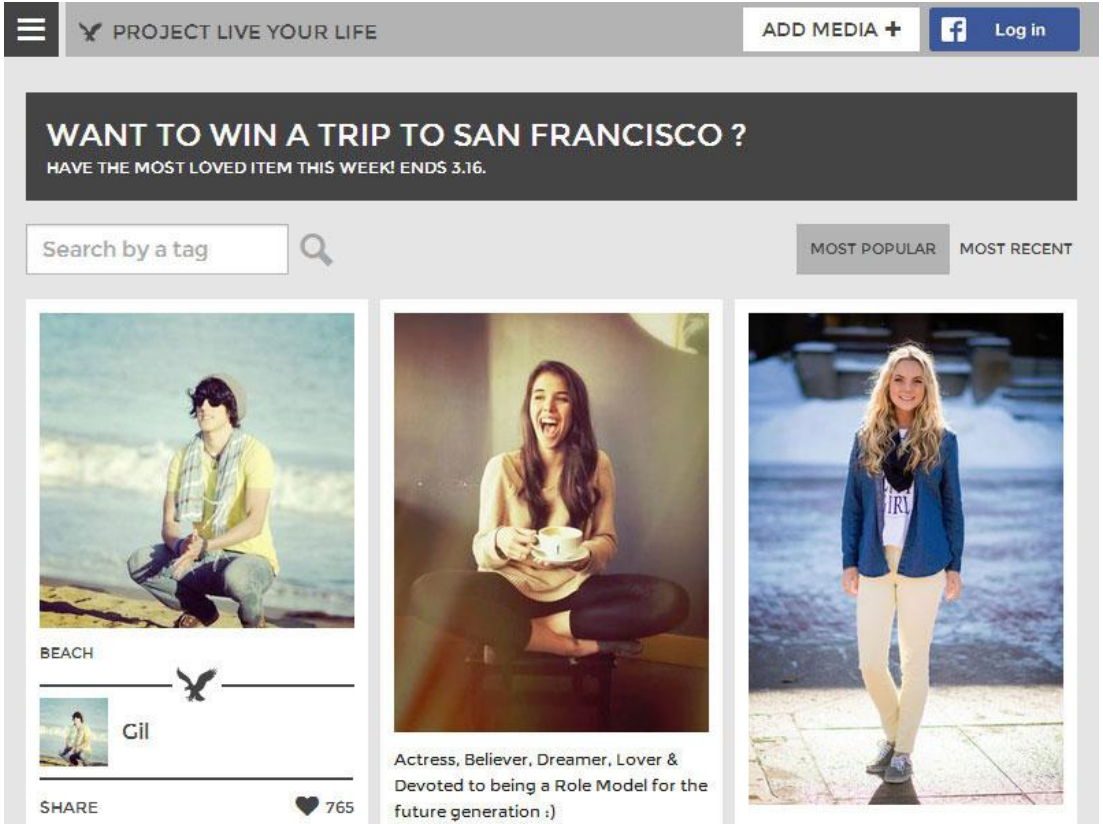
1. Minimize the barriers for users to register, upload, and vote.
2. Promote engagement by focusing on photo content first.
3. Build a flexible tagging system and interface that serves both users and admins.



Architecture for contest experience.

Results

1. User registration crushed the previous year's multi-week contest in just two days (over 11,000 profiles created).
2. During those two days, user votes also surpassed the previous contest's total by casting 80,000 votes for their favorite photos.
3. Client admins ran the overall contest plus weekly contests with almost no technical help.



Design of contest homepage (I collaborated with a visual designer).

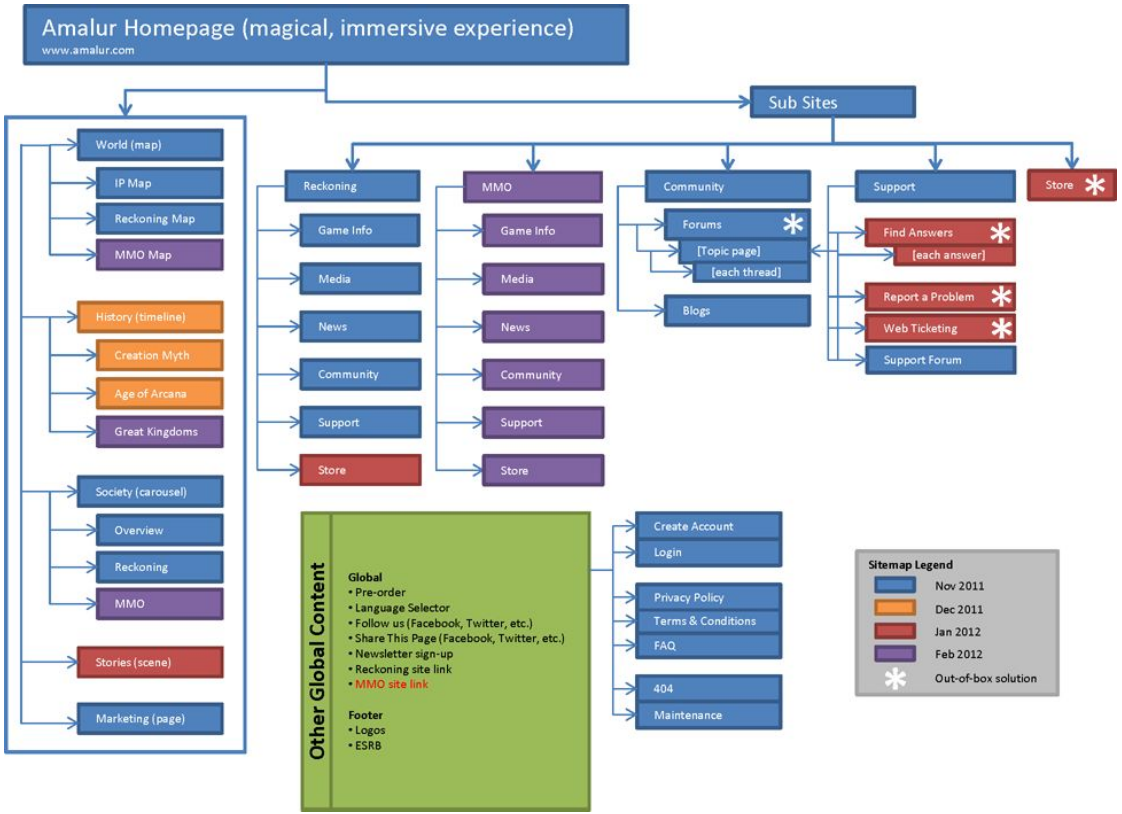
A New World

10,000 Years of Made-up History on the Web

38 Studios needed to build an audience for a new fantasy world prior to the flagship game launch.

Solution

1. Blend the arts of storytelling and technology to create an immersive experience.
2. Deliver informative content that fulfills the brand promise of a deep fantasy world.
3. Draw fans into a living world by releasing a steady stream of engaging updates.



Architecture of main site and child sites.

Results

1. With no advertising, Amalur.com was visited by more than 200,000 unique visitors over the course of six months.
2. Users averaged about three minutes per page for each visit and up to six minutes on long-form content pages.
3. Over 35,000 words of illustrated content updates were written, edited, and published.

Design of interactive world map (I wrote and managed all the content in my job as copywriter).

Want More?

I am happy to provide in-depth samples or demo my latest work upon request.

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